

## DISANN KATENDE, MPH

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Hiring Committee  
Health Analytics and Insights Branch, Data and Analytics Strategy Division  
Ontario Ministry of Health

### Re: Health Analyst — Job ID 248428

I am writing to apply for the Health Analyst position with the Health Analytics and Insights Branch. I am a research epidemiologist and public health data analyst with 12 years of experience conducting quantitative health research, interpreting complex health data, and translating evidence into recommendations for policy, planning, program, and funding decisions. Based in Toronto, I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my analytical expertise and practical understanding of health-system data to the Ministry's reporting, evaluation, and performance-measurement work.

In my current role as a Research Epidemiologist with the World Health Organization, I lead spatial analysis of mass drug administration coverage across 238 clusters in Southern Malawi, synthesizing surveillance findings into assessments that inform program decisions with in-country partners. I also build coverage-monitoring dashboards that organize complex data into clear, decision-ready information for program leadership. This work requires selecting appropriate analytical approaches, interpreting patterns and anomalies, assessing limitations, and communicating results to both technical and non-technical audiences.

Previously, as a Research Analyst with CAREX Canada at the BC Centre for Disease Control and the University of British Columbia, I led quantitative research on occupational and environmental health risks, including carcinogen exposure among new and immigrant workers and lead in BC school drinking water. I analyzed exposure-disease associations using linked administrative datasets of more than 100 million records in Statistics Canada's Secure Research Environment, assessed data quality and linkage limitations across national sources, and produced evidence used to inform exposure-reduction recommendations. My work has included peer-reviewed publication and the preparation of clear findings for public health, workplace-safety, and other decision-making audiences.

I bring technical experience with SQL, R, SAS, Python, ArcGIS Pro, and QGIS, along with practical knowledge of epidemiology, population health, health geography, data governance, and secure health-data management. As Senior Coordinator at the First Nations Health Authority, I led the BC First Nations Regional Health Survey, coordinating field teams and negotiating data-governance and logistics arrangements across community and organizational stakeholders under OCAP-compliant data management. Combined with my service on the CIHR/PHAC Community Advisory Committee, this experience has strengthened my ability to build collaborative relationships, provide analytical advice, manage concurrent deliverables, and translate technical information into useful guidance for varied audiences.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background in health analytics, research, reporting, stakeholder engagement, and data governance can support the Health Analytics and Insights Branch. I appreciate your consideration.

Sincerely,

Disann Katende, MPH